MINUTES OF THE CLARE COUNTY BOARD OF COMMISSIONERS

Approved 7/17/25 lm

225 W. Main St.
Harrison, Michigan 48625

~~Unapproved~~ minutes
June 18, 2025

Meeting was called to order at 9:00 a.m.

Pledge of Allegiance to the Flag of the United States of America

District 2 Dale Majewski, District 3 Jacob Gross, District 4 Jeff Haskell, District 5 David Hoefling, District 6 Jack Kleinhardt, District 7 Gabe Ambrozaitis, District 8 George Gilmore and District 9 Rick Fancon

COMMISSIONERS ABSENT

District 1 Marlene Housler

OTHERS PRESENT

Clerk & Register of Deeds Lori Mott, Administrator Lori Phelps, Treasurer Jenny Beemer-Fritzinger, Deputy Clerk Isha Walter, members of the public and zoom participants

APPROVAL OF AGENDA

It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Fancon to approve the agenda as amended, **Motion carried.**

*Amendment: After Administrator's Report add Roxanne Foster from the Michigan Department of Treasury presenting the 2024 Audit.

APPROVAL OF MINUTES

It was moved by Commissioner Ambrozaitis, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to approve the Board of Commissioners Minutes of May 21, 2025, **Motion carried.**

GENERAL PUBLIC COMMENT

None

COMMUNICATIONS LIST

1. Resolutions Recognizing Juneteenth and Pride Month in Genesee County – No discussion
2. Denise Neff resignation from Department of Health and Human Services (DHHS) Board – No Discussion

ADMINISTRATOR'S REPORT

Administrator Lori Phelps provided the Commissioners with updates from Senate Bills she is watching, county maintenance and the 2025 budget. She also requested the Commissioners set up a Fund Balance Policy and will provide a draft policy to the July Board of Commissioners' Meeting.

Roxanne Foster, Senior Auditor Michigan Department of Treasury
Ms. Foster gave an overview of the 2024 County Audit noting deficiencies, expenditures in excess of appropriation and that the uniform chart of accounts was not completely developed at the time of the audit but is in the works and improvements have been made. Ms. Foster asked for any discussion or questions, no comments were made and no questions were asked of the auditor.

CLOSED SESSION

It was moved by Commissioner Hoefling, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to go into closed session to discuss the negotiation of a collective bargaining agreement. (MCL 15.268(c)), roll call vote revealed:

Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Hoefling, Majewski, Haskell, Gross, Fancon, Kleinhardt, Ambrozaitis and Gilmore
Nays: (0)
Absent: (1) being Commissioner Housler
Motion carried.

Entered into closed session at 9:22 a.m.
Back in open session at 10:10 a.m.

PUBLIC HEARINGS/SPECIAL PRESENTATIONS

1. Lori Phelps – Introduce 2026 Budget
   Administrator Phelps passed out the 2026 budget and a draft Capital Improvement Plan for the Commissioners to review prior to the July meeting.

JUSTICE

1. Homeland Security/Emergency Management
   It was moved by Commissioner Ambrozaitis, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to approve the Sixth District-Regional Mutual Aid Agreement.

HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

No discussion

PHYSICAL RESOURCES AND ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

1. Equalization Clare County
   It was moved by Commissioner Fancon, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to approve the L-4029 2025 Tax Rate Request in the amount of $1,560,910,870 which is the maximum allowable millage levy of 4.6418, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Fancon, Hoefling, Haskell, Gilmore, Majewski, Gross, Fancon and Keinhardt
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (1) being Commissioner Housler
   Motion carried.

2. Drain-Lake Level Resolution
   It was moved by Commissioner Kleinhardt, seconded by Commissioner Fancon to adopt Resolution #25-13 for Crooked Lake pursuant to MCL 324.30701, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Kleinhardt, Fancon, Haskell, Gilmore, Ambrozaitis, Hoefling, Gross and Majewski
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (1) being Commissioner Housler
   Motion carried.

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION

1. Statutory Finance Committee
   It was moved by Commissioner Haskell, seconded by Commissioner Gross in the amount of $123,266.16 and the meeting minutes of June 9, 2025 in the amount of $142,964.25, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Haskell, Gross, Fancon, Kleinhardt, Hoefling, Ambrozaitis, Gilmore and Majewski
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (1) being Commissioner Housler
   Motion carried.

2. Monthly Expenditures
   It was moved by Commissioner Gross, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to approve the expenditures for the month of May, in the amount of $1,548,617.89 with the General Fund expenditures totaling $695,762.67, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Gross, Haskell, Fancon, Kleinhardt, Hoefling, Ambrozaitis, Gilmore and Majewski
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (1) being Commissioner Housler
   Motion carried.

3. Budget Adjustments
   It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Gross to approve Budget Adjustments #25-104 and #25-117 in the amount of $245,384.46 and $70,000 respectively, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Majewski, Gross, Fancon, Kleinhardt, Hoefling, Ambrozaitis, Gilmore and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (1) being Commissioner Housler
   Motion carried.

CLERK/REGISTER OF DEEDS REPORT

Clerk and Register of Deeds Lori Mott reported that her office attended the Senior Services Community Day and signed several seniors up for Property Fraud Alert along with the Veteran's Monthly Coffee Hour, each month more Veterans sign up for Property Fraud Alert.

TREASURER'S REPORT

Treasurer Jenny Beemer-Fritzinger provided all the statutory reports to the Commissioners. Tax foreclosure land sale will be held on August 22, 2025 and will be online only. There are potentially 4 or 5 demolitions that may happen. Starting week of July 1st will be property visits, approximately 750, to personally visit and hand out tax forfeiture notices. Treasurer's office works with people to create payment plans for taxes and most of the public doesn't know that they do that.

CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Chairman George Gilmore reported that Community Mental Health has taken a hit financially.

VICE CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Vice Chairman Rick Fancon had no report

COMMISSIONER'S REPORT

Commissioner Hoefling has attended his meetings and gave a report on each of the townships and committees he represents.

Commissioner Gross reported on the Farwell Lumberjack Festival scheduled for July and has had a lot of questions from constituents regarding the 911 rescue response problem in Clare County and finally reported that he will be attending his Substance Abuse Disorder Policy Board Meeting that evening with MidState in Lansing.

Commissioner Ambrozaitis reported that 5 members of the Michigan Army National Guard spent some time at the County Airport to perform a survey and design of the County Airport. There is a federal program called Innovative Readiness Training. The military needs to do training and they need new and unique innovative ways to do that training. This unit came from Ishpaming in the Upper Peninsula and provided this survey and design free of charge for the training experience. Commissioner Ambrozaitis tried to get local contractors to bid finishing the County Airport Terminal without success so he asked this unit to provide the design and build packet. They will also look at the drainage on the Airport, the South entrance, the West entrance, the West perimeter road, the taxiways, the turf runway and design a new runway. Those survey and design build packets are then provided to units that will come and build the projects free of labor charges. The only charge would be for materials and fuel used onsite. Approval could be in the next 4-5 months from the military. This airport project provides needed training for these military units. One of the units is tasked with building and maintaining war time airports and this is a great training opportunity for them.

Commissioner Haskell reported the unemployment rate is 8.4% for Clare County.

Commissioner Kleinhardt reported that it looks like the revenue sharing is on track to stay the same, but Medicaid cuts may be coming.

Commissioner Majewski had no report

STATE OF THE COUNTY BUDGET

Administrator Phelps reported on the budget in her Administrator's Report.

PUBLIC COMMENT

None

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

None

NEW BUSINESS

1. Hiring an Airport Manager
   Administrator Phelps asked that the Board allocate $7,000 to the Airport for the remainder of this fiscal year to hire an Airport Manager. It has been difficult for the Administrator to act as Airport Manager with all her other duties.

   It was moved by Commissioner Fancon, seconded by Commissioner Gross to put $7,000 back in the budget for an Airport Manager for the remainder of the fiscal year, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (8) being Commissioners Fancon, Gross, Majewski, Kleinhardt, Hoefling, Ambrozaitis, Gilmore, Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (1) being Commissioner Housler
   Motion carried.

It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Ambrozaitis to adjourn, **motion carried.**

Meeting adjourned at 10:48 a.m.

Lori Mott, Clerk
Clare County Board of Commissioners

George Gilmore, Chairman
Clare County Board of Commissioners